

6 Medical ethics: beginning and end of life issues	6.1	Issues in medical ethics with a focus on beginning and end of life debates (4) a) The status of the embryo, concepts of sanctity and value of life from religious and secular perspectives, embryo research, pre-implantation genetic diagnosis (PGD), stem cells and cord blood, fertilisation <i>in vitro</i> and destruction of embryos, abortion. b) Assisted dying, euthanasia, palliative care. Religious and secular contributions to all these issues, legal position, concepts of rights and responsibilities, personhood and human nature, options and choices. c) Strengths and weaknesses of significant areas of disagreement and debate, assessment of relevant examples, legal changes and social attitudes, appropriateness and value of employing religious perspectives into these debates, assessment and comparison of contrasting positions. With reference to the ideas of P Singer and J Glover.
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List of extracts for Paper 2: Religion and Ethics

Students are expected to study a range of texts that support and underpin their knowledge and understanding. The assessment will include two extended-response questions on an excerpt, sourced from this extracts list. The following texts are **not** exclusive to the topic areas under which they appear; students will need to be able to apply these texts across any suitable topic area. These are published in the *A level Religious Studies Anthology: Paper 2 – Religion and Ethics* which can be downloaded from our website.

- (1) Barclay W – *Ethics in a Permissive Society*, Chapter 4 Situation Ethics, pp. 69–91 (HarperCollins Distribution Services, 1972) ISBN 9780002152044
- (2) Kant I – *Groundwork for the Metaphysics of Morals*, Text, second section, pp. 29–53 (Yale University Press, 2002) ISBN 9780300094879
- (3) Aristotle – *The Nicomachean Ethics*, Book II, Moral Virtue, pp. 23–37 (Oxford World's Classics edition, 1980) ISBN 9780192815187
- (4) Wilcockson M – *Issues of Life and Death*, Chapter 4 Euthanasia and Doctors' Ethics, pp. 56–69 (Hodder Education, 1999) ISBN 9780340724880

Assessment information

- First assessment: May/June 2018.
- The assessment is 2 hours.
- The assessment is out of 80 marks.
- The assessment consists of three sections.
- Students must answer all questions in Section A, Section B and Section C.
- The paper includes short-open, open-response and extended writing questions.
- See *Appendix 1* for the command words that will be used in the examination paper.
- Use of specialist language will be assessed as it is through the selection and deployment of specialist language and terminology that students are able to demonstrate their knowledge and understanding of religion and belief.

Synoptic assessment

Synoptic assessment requires students to work across different parts of a qualification and to show their accumulated knowledge and understanding of a topic or subject area.

Synoptic assessment enables students to show their ability to combine their skills, knowledge and understanding with breadth and depth of the subject.

Students will be able to demonstrate this through the extended essay in Question 4.

Sample assessment materials

A sample paper and mark scheme can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 3 Advanced GCE in Religious Studies Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs)* document.